Initial Market Validation Survey

Development of an Intelligent Healthcare Financial Reconciliation and Patient Billing Platform (MedCore)

Good day!

We are conducting a market validation study for the development of MedCore, a digital healthcare financial platform designed to resolve hospital discharge delays, billing confusion, and administrative bottlenecks in Philippine healthcare. MedCore introduces an automated system that connects hospital billing, government benefits, and private insurance to provide patients and their families with transparent, real-time digital billing statements and rapid mobile discharge clearance.

Your responses will remain strictly confidential in accordance with the Data Privacy Act of 2012 and will be used solely for research purposes.

Estimated completion time: 5–7 minutes

I. Socio-Economic Profile

1. Name (optional):

Name: _____

2. Age Group:

- ☐ 18 and below
- ☐ 18–24 years old
- ☐ 25–34 years old
- ☐ 35–44 years old
- ☐ 45–54 years old
- ☐ 55 years old and older

3. Gender:

- ☐ Male
- ☐ Female
- ☐ Prefer not to say

4. Municipality or City of Residence (Region II):

Cagayan

- ☐ Tuguegarao City
- ☐ Aparri
- ☐ Baggao
- ☐ Iguig
- ☐ Solana
- ☐ Enrile
- ☐ Lal-lo
- ☐ Peñablanca
- ☐ Tuao
- ☐ Other Cagayan municipality: _____

Isabela

- ☐ Ilagan City
- ☐ Cauayan City
- ☐ Santiago City

- ☐ Other Isabela municipality: _____

Nueva Vizcaya

- ☐ Bayombong
- ☐ Solano
- ☐ Other Nueva Vizcaya municipality: _____

Quirino

- ☐ Cabarroguis
- ☐ Other Quirino municipality: _____

Batanes

- ☐ Basco
- ☐ Other Batanes municipality: _____

5. Occupation:

- ☐ Student
- ☐ Government Employee
- ☐ Private Sector Employee
- ☐ Self-employed / Freelancer
- ☐ Business Owner
- ☐ Healthcare Professional
- ☐ Retired / Senior Citizen
- ☐ Others, please specify: _____

6. Monthly Household Income (in Philippine Pesos):

- ☐ Below 25,000
- ☐ 25,000–49,999
- ☐ 50,000–99,999
- ☐ 100,000–149,999
- ☐ 150,000 and above

7. Healthcare Coverage Status (Check all that apply):

- ☐ Philippine Health Insurance Corporation member / dependent
- ☐ Private Health Maintenance Organization cardholder
- ☐ Qualified Senior Citizen privilege holder
- ☐ Qualified Persons with Disabilities privilege holder
- ☐ Solo Parent privilege holder
- ☐ Direct out-of-pocket / Cash payer only

II. Current Hospital Billing and Discharge Experience

1. What has been your most recent role in a hospital admission setting?

- ☐ Admitted personally as an inpatient
- ☐ Patient companion or watcher handling billing
- ☐ Outpatient or emergency room visitor
- ☐ Have not experienced hospital admission recently

2. On average, how long did you wait for billing clearance from doctor discharge order until release?

- ☐ Less than 1 hour
- ☐ 1 to 2 hours
- ☐ 2 to 4 hours
- ☐ 4 to 8 hours
- ☐ More than 8 hours / Had to stay overnight

3. What were the primary causes of delay during your discharge? (Check all that apply):

- ☐ Waiting for doctor professional fee forms
- ☐ Manual computation and printing of paper bills
- ☐ Verification of Philippine Health Insurance benefits
- ☐ Waiting for Health Maintenance Organization approval
- ☐ Resolving disputed or unexpected charges
- ☐ Long queues at the hospital cashier window
- ☐ Others, please specify: _____

4. How clear and understandable was your final hospital statement of account?

- ☐ Very clear and easy to understand
- ☐ Moderately understandable but contained confusing medical terms
- ☐ Difficult to understand with unclear deduction computations
- ☐ Completely unclear, leading to surprise charges and unexpected out-of-pocket expenses

5. What is your primary payment method when settling hospital bills?

- ☐ Physical cash at the cashier window
- ☐ Debit or credit card
- ☐ Mobile electronic wallet (such as GCash or Maya)
- ☐ Online bank transfer
- ☐ Promissory note or government assistance guarantee letter

III. Attitudes Towards Hospital Billing Transparency

Rate your agreement: 5 = Strongly Agree | 4 = Agree | 3 = Neutral | 2 = Disagree | 1 = Strongly Disagree

Statement	5	4	3	2	1
1. Prolonged discharge waiting times cause severe stress, anxiety, and frustration for patients and their families.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
2. Traditional multi-page paper hospital bills are confusing, difficult to read, and lack itemized clarity.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
3. Patients should be able to view a running breakdown of their hospital charges on their mobile phones while still admitted.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
4. Government statutory discounts and insurance deductions should be automatically computed to maximize patient benefits without manual paperwork.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
5. Being able to pay hospital bills digitally through mobile phones instead of waiting in physical cashier lines would greatly improve the healthcare experience.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
6. Hospital discharge clearance should take less than forty-five minutes once the doctor declares the patient fit to leave.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

IV. Product Validation

Imagine a digital healthcare financial platform that:

- ☐ Tracks running hospital charges in real time using simple, plain-language categories
- ☐ Automatically coordinates Philippine Health Insurance Corporation and private insurance to maximize benefits
- ☐ Sends an itemized, plain-language digital statement directly to your mobile phone
- ☐ Enables one-click digital payment and issues an electronic discharge clearance pass

1. How interested would you be in using this platform during a hospital stay?

- ☐ Extremely interested
- ☐ Very interested
- ☐ Moderately interested
- ☐ Slightly interested
- ☐ Not interested

2. Which platform features would benefit you the most? (Check all that apply):

- ☐ Real-time tracking of ongoing hospital charges
- ☐ Maximized insurance and statutory deductions
- ☐ Plain-language breakdown of doctor fees
- ☐ One-click mobile payment via digital wallets
- ☐ Digital promissory note generator for installments
- ☐ Digital discharge pass allowing immediate departure

3. How often do you think you would use this platform?

- ☐ Every hospital admission
- ☐ Only for major surgical or prolonged stays
- ☐ Occasionally
- ☐ Never

4. Which features would you like to have? (Check all that apply)

- ☐ Real-time billing notifications via Short Message Service
- ☐ Itemized doctor professional fee tracker
- ☐ Live insurance approval status monitor
- ☐ Digital discharge clearance pass
- ☐ Flexible installment payment calculator
- ☐ Prescriptive breakdown of insurance vs out-of-pocket

5. What concerns would prevent you from using the platform? (Check all that apply):

- ☐ Data privacy and confidentiality of medical records
- ☐ Weak cellular reception or internet inside hospital
- ☐ Complicated or difficult-to-use user interface
- ☐ Distrust in accuracy of automated calculations
- ☐ Possible extra convenience fees for digital payments
- ☐ Others, please specify: _____

6. If the platform required access to your insurance records to verify benefits, would you allow it?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Not sure

7. If this platform is offered by the hospital as a free mobile service, how likely are you to use it? (Rate from 1 to 10, where 1 means Completely Unlikely and 10 means Extremely Likely):

Rating (1–10): _____

V. Willingness to Adopt Digital Clearance and Payments

1. Assuming the digital statement is clear and accurate, how often would you choose mobile digital settlement over waiting in physical hospital cashier lines?

- ☐ Never
- ☐ Rarely
- ☐ Sometimes
- ☐ Often
- ☐ Always

2. Which payment channels would you prefer to use for settling residual hospital balances?

- ☐ Mobile electronic wallets (such as GCash or Maya)
- ☐ Interoperable national Quick Response codes
- ☐ Online bank transfer
- ☐ Credit or debit card
- ☐ Structured installment plans through digital promissory agreements

3. What factors would most encourage you to shift to digital hospital clearance? (Select top three):

- ☐ Guaranteed discharge clearance in under forty-five minutes
- ☐ Certified accuracy of statutory discounts and insurance benefits
- ☐ Zero additional transaction or convenience fees
- ☐ Instant generation of official electronic receipts
- ☐ Simple mobile interface requiring no app download
- ☐ Friendly assistance from hospital staff if questions arise

Thank you for your time and valuable feedback!